

Speak English With Vanessa

Free PDF Worksheet

Phrases I Say Every Day: Compilation

Dear English Learner,

Get ready to speak confidently! I recommend reading the worksheet out loud and using the blank space on the last page to answer my challenge question. [Click here to watch the original video](#). Thanks so much for learning English with me!

*Your teacher,
Vanessa*

Common Phrases I Use Daily

Whip up something to eat *To quickly make something to eat, like a sandwich or a snack*

- After I make my to-do list, I **whip up something to eat**, usually scrambled eggs, toast, and fresh fruit.
- I am going to **whip up something to eat** before we go on a walk.

Come on, let's go! *A phrase you say to someone when you are ready to leave somewhere*

- When it's time to leave for school, I tell my kids "**Come on, let's go!**"
- **Come on, let's go!** We don't want to miss the show!

We don't wanna be late! *A phrase to emphasize why you need to leave soon*

- To make sure our kids understand the importance of being on time, I like to tell them "**We don't wanna be late!**" It's never too soon to start building those good habits!
- **We don't wanna be late** for the concert, so we should leave soon.

I'm stuck in traffic, but I'm on my way *This is a phrase you would use if you are running late for a meeting or appointment*

- “Hey Dan, **I'm stuck in traffic, but I'm on my way**. I'll be there in about 5 minutes.”
- I'm running late for my doctor appointment so I called to let them know **I'm stuck in traffic, but I'm on my way**.

I'm gonna run some errands *A phrase you use when you have a lot of things you need to get done outside the house, like go grocery shopping, go to the bank or the post office, etc.*

- After my meeting with Dan, **I'm gonna run some errands** around town.
- While the kids are at the birthday party, **I'm gonna run some errands**.

I better run *Another way of saying “I should go” or “I need to go now”*

- **I better run**, I have a few more things to finish before the kids get out of school.
- I need to be at my meeting by one o'clock, so **I better run**.

How was everyone's day? *A common phrase that parents will ask their kids at the end of the school day*

- The first thing I ask when I pick my kids up from school is “**How was everyone's day?**”
- “**How was everyone's day?** Did you learn anything interesting?”

What did you do today? *Another common phrase that parents will ask their kids, usually to try to get them to engage in conversation*

- “Hey boys, how was school? **What did you do today?**”
- **What did you do today?** Tell me all about your day.

What do you think? *A way of asking for someone's opinion or feedback on something*

- I was thinking we should order pizza for dinner tonight. **What do you think?**
- I think I'll wear this dress to the party on Saturday. **What do you think?**

Start winding down *A phrase used to imply the ending of a task or project or a calming or lowering of energy, like at bedtime*

- “Ok everyone, it’s time to **start winding down**. Let’s put on PJs and brush our teeth!”
- I like to turn off my phone when it is time to **start winding down** at night.

I’m looking forward to... *This is a phrase you would use when you are excited about something that is going to happen in the future*

- **I’m looking forward to** going on vacation with my family.
- I haven’t seen my friend in so long, **I’m looking forward to** seeing her this weekend.

I’m thinking about...what do you think? *In this phrase, you express your own opinion or thoughts first, then ask for the other person’s opinion or thoughts*

- **I’m thinking about** cutting my hair really short. **What do you think?**
- **I’m thinking about** starting my own business this year. **What do you think?**

Be careful that you don’t... *This phrase is meant as a warning or caution to someone*

- **Be careful that you don’t** use the same password for every account that you use online.
- **Be careful that you don’t** forget sunscreen when you go to the beach!

Thanks to... *This phrase is meant to express gratitude to someone or something, but it can also be used in a sarcastic way, where you blame someone or something for an outcome*

- **Thanks to** your support, this business is a success.
- **Thanks to** the flat tire I had this morning, I missed my meeting.

As far as I know... *This phrase is used when you are not absolutely sure about something or you may be wrong*

- **As far as I know**, we don't have anything planned this weekend, but let me check the calendar.
- **As far as I know**, you don't have to have a reservation to get a table at that restaurant, you can just show up.

...as _____ as possible *This phrase is used to emphasize urgency or precision*

- This project needs to be finished **as soon as possible**.
- I want to get to the airport **as early as possible** so that we don't miss our flight.

Speaking of... *This is a way of introducing a topic related to something that you were talking about*

- **Speaking of** projects, how is your work going?
- **Speaking of** flights, how was your trip to Spain?

We may/might as well... *This is a way of saying that something should be done or accepted because it cannot be avoided or because there is no good reason not to do it*

- Our flight was canceled because of the storm, so **we may/might as well** make other vacation plans.
- It's a beautiful day today, **we may/might as well** walk to the park and enjoy the sunshine!

This doesn't mean that...it just means that... *This is a phrase you use when something may not turn out exactly as you hoped and you have to compromise or adjust your expectation*

- **This doesn't mean that** you can't go to both parties this weekend, **it just means that** you will have to leave one early or be late to the other one.
- **This doesn't mean that** you won't get a good job, **it just means that** it might take a while before you're hired.

I would rather ... than ... *This is a phrase to emphasize something that you want or prefer over something else*

- **I would rather** have a quiet night at home **than** go to a crowded, noisy bar or club.
- **I would rather** wait for the job that I really want **than** work a job that I don't like.

Like clockwork *When something runs smoothly and easily, or with regular timing*

- **Like clockwork**, we wake up in the mornings, get dressed, eat breakfast, and get ready to start the day.
- **Like clockwork**, my cats wake me up at the same time every morning.

Slowly but surely *Something that happens slowly but reliably, rather than quickly*

- **Slowly but surely**, as they get older, my two boys are able to do more for themselves in the mornings.
- I started running last summer and **slowly but surely**, I have been able to run longer distances.

I've gotten in the habit of... *To start doing something so that it becomes a habit*

- **I've gotten in the habit of** not looking at my phone until after 9 AM and not looking at it after 8 PM.
- **I've gotten in the habit of** drinking hot tea every night after dinner.

Putting it off *To delay doing something or change it to a later date*

- I have a list of things that I have been **putting off** that I am going to get done today, like mail these letters, go to the bank, and return this item to the store where I bought it.
- I have been **putting off** going to the dentist because I hate the sound that the drill makes.

It's a hassle *A situation that is difficult and requires a lot of effort*

- **It's a hassle** trying to get all these things done in one day, but I know they all need to be done, so I am going to try my best.
- **It's a hassle** to travel with cats, so when we go on vacation, I have friends or family come by the house and check on them.

As it turns out *To contrast between a possible situation and what is actually happening*

- **As it turns out**, the mechanic isn't open today, so I can move on to the next item on my list.
- **As it turns out**, I wrote the date down wrong in my planner and my appointment isn't today, it's next week.

Go with the flow *To be relaxed, to do the easiest thing, to not have a plan*

- During the week, I am focused and work hard. But on the weekends, I like to **go with the flow**.
- We usually plan a lot of activities for our vacations, but this time we wanted to relax and **go with the flow**.

That being said *In spite of or nevertheless*

- **That being said**, I still like to have a plan for how I am going to spend my time on the weekend, whether it's going on a hike with my family or getting things done around the house.
- I don't usually enjoy amusement parks. **That being said**, it was a lot of fun to see the kids having so much fun.

Now that I think about it *When you realize something or want to change your mind about something*

- Actually, **now that I think about it**, friends always asked to borrow my notes to study for tests in college. So maybe I was organized back then after all.
- **Now that I think about it**, I never went to amusement parks when I was a kid.

That's beside the point *Something that isn't relevant to what is being talked about*

- Whether I get my whole task list finished for the day or not is **beside the point**—the important thing is having a plan and knowing which tasks are most important.
- Where we go on vacation is **beside the point**. The point is to spend time together and make memories.

On a roll *To have a streak of activity or success*

- I am **on a roll** today, I've gotten almost everything done on my to-do list and it's not even lunch!
- They scored three goals in a row, they're really **on a roll**!

To do something ahead of time *To complete something before it needs to be finished*

- I try to make lunches **ahead of time**, but sometimes I end up making them in the morning before they leave for school.
- I like to get all my work done **ahead of time** so that I have time to do a good job and not be rushed.

Get out of hand *Something that is not under control*

- Sometimes the dishes and laundry **get out of hand** during the week because we get so busy.
- After the kids ate a cake and a whole plate of cookies, the party **got out of hand**.

Too bad *A phrase used to express a regret or wishing that something was different*

- It's **too bad** we don't have a maid to clean our house every day.
- It's **too bad** that our vacation is only a week—I'm having so much fun!

When the time comes *When something happens at the appropriate time, in the future*

- **When the time comes** for Matilda to go to school, it will probably be pretty quiet in the house during the day.
- I am going to keep studying and working hard so that **when the time comes** for my exam, I am prepared.

Some fresh air *Going outdoors to take a break and refresh yourself*

- I've been inside all morning. Let's go outside and get **some fresh air**.
- When I need to boost my mood and energy, I like to go for a walk and get **some fresh air**.

There's something about... *When someone or something has a quality that influences you but it's hard to describe*

- **There's something about** going outside and taking a break in the middle of the day that makes me feel so much better!
- **There's something about** her that reminds me of my sister, but I can't put my finger on it.

Come to think of it *A phrase used when a point or idea comes to you while you're speaking*

- **Come to think of it**, I think it's snack time and I know just what to make.
- **Come to think of it**, I haven't heard from her in a while. I think I'll give her a call.

To be spoiled *To be treated incredibly well, indulged, or pampered*

- We're so **spoiled** because our neighbors always share good food with us.
- My parents love **to spoil** their grandkids by giving them anything and everything they want.

The fact that *An established fact or truth*

I love **the fact that** our neighbors all do what we can to take care of each other. It's a great community to have a family in.

My family has finally accepted **the fact that** I don't eat meat.

Quiz Time!

See the answers on final page, after the challenge question

1. I _____, I have to go meet a friend for lunch.
 - a. put it off
 - b. better run
 - c. get out of hand

2. I need to _____ around town.
 - a. run some errands
 - b. get on a roll
 - c. start winding down

3. At night I like to have a cup of hot tea to help me _____.
 - a. put it off
 - b. get out of hand
 - c. start winding down

4. I'm thinking about moving to the forest to live in a treehouse. _____.
 - a. What do you think?
 - b. We don't wanna be late!
 - c. I'm stuck in traffic, but I'm on my way.

5. _____ my alarm clock breaking, I was late to work this morning.
 - a. Too bad
 - b. Thanks to
 - c. As it turns out

6. _____, she is coming to the party on Saturday.
 - a. Slowly but surely
 - b. Too bad
 - c. As far as I know

7. I want to leave for vacation _____, I don't want to wait another week!
 - a. as soon as possible
 - b. slowly but surely
 - c. as far as I know

8. The kids had too much sugar at the party and _____.
a. ran some errands
b. got out of hand
c. got some fresh air
9. I started working out and _____ I got stronger.
a. slowly but surely
b. when the time comes
c. too bad
10. I am _____ today—I have finished my to-do list, run errands, and gone for a walk.
a. putting it off
b. like clockwork
c. on a roll

Vanessa's Challenge Question

Use the space below to write a few sentences answering this question.

Using some of the phrases and vocabulary you learned in this lesson, write about your daily routine using at least 3 of the phrases.

Sample: When I was working at my old job, my stress levels got out of hand. I was getting really unhealthy and I knew something needed to change as soon as possible. Thanks to yoga, I am less stressed and I like to go with the flow, taking one day at a time.

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Quiz answers:

1. b. better run
2. a. run some errands
3. c. start winding down
4. a. What do you think?
5. b. Thanks to
6. c. As far as I know
7. a. as soon as possible
8. b. got out of hand
9. a. slowly but surely
10. c. on a roll